

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

to work out a debt. In fact, most of those I know sincerely respect their commitment to honesty and sacrifice.

Just be certain you're not asking the doctor or dentist to support your indulgences. Before you ask them to sacrifice, look for what you can surrender first.

The best source of health comes not from a book or a doctor, but from God. If you are ill and allow Him to remove the worry and anxiety caused by finances, you will find that both your financial life and medical life will improve.

CATEGORY 8: MISCELLANEOUS

"Miscellaneous" is that category of the budget that seems to eat up all your money and you can never remember where it went. About 5-7 percent of your total spending should be allocated for gifts, ice cream sundaes, and so on. I recommend that at least once a year a husband and wife both keep a diary for 30 days and write down what they spend miscellaneously. You will probably be shocked at the amount. It is surprising how much money you can put into soft drink and candy machines without realizing it.

Miscellaneous is one of those categories that develops creeping inflation. Have you ever noticed that if you carry \$10 with you while shopping, you'll spend it; but if you carry \$100, you'll spend that.

I don't know of any alternative method to control miscellaneous spending except to determine what your budget will allow and *stick to it*.

In our miscellaneous budget we include: toiletry items (toothpaste, razors, shampoo, et cetera), cash we carry (equally divided), lunch money, gifts, and all the other items that don't fit easily into any other category.

I can't emphasize too much that this is a category that can grow beyond proportion if you don't watch it carefully. There is no substitute for self-discipline when it comes to controlling miscellaneous.

One question commonly asked by Christian families is, "Where do Christian school expenses fit in?" For lack of another